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🌐 School Profile

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EDUCATION

•University of Utah

2022 Aug - Current

research interest: Digital Platforms, Open Source, Artificial Intelligence, Intangible Assets, Corporate Finance

Ph.D., Finance

•Seoul National University

2019 - 2021

M.S., Finance

•University of Seoul

2013 - 2019

B.A., Business Administration

JOB MARKET PAPER

•Commoditize Your Complement: Strategic Open-Source Releases and the Cannibalization of Rival Firms

Won, P. Y. (2026). Available at SSRN.

- Presented at: *EUROFIDAI-ESSEC Paris December Finance Meeting (2026, scheduled)*, *FMA Asia/Pacific Conference (2026, scheduled)*, *36th Annual Conference on Financial Economics and Accounting (CFEA 2026, scheduled)*
- Why do firms release open-source software (OSS) for free? I show that platforms strategically release OSS to commoditize complementary product markets, eroding rivals' proprietary rents while expanding demand for their own products. Using the staggered release of GitHub repositories, I find that complement rivals lose 8.2% of sales, cut R&D by 13.1%, and reallocate engineering talent to the platform, whereas direct substitutes show no measurable reaction. The platforms benefit in turn: their core-segment sales rise about 42% more than non-core segments, lifting sales and profitability. Equity markets price each release as a directed wealth transfer, with platforms gaining \$313 billion as complement rivals lose \$153 billion. Free OSS emerges as a non-priced competitive weapon beyond the reach of traditional antitrust.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

WORKING PAPERS

•(Digital) Platform Data Power

Won, P. Y. (2026). Available at SSRN.

- Presented at: *Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting (2026, scheduled)*, *2nd HKU Next-Gen Finance PhD Workshop (2026)*, *FMA Asia/Pacific Conference (2026, scheduled)*
- How do digital platforms exploit their dual role as marketplace operators to strategically compete with third-party sellers? To answer this, I introduce the Data Power Index (DPI), a novel measure quantifying Amazon's accumulated informational advantage. Unlike traditional market power measures such as the HHI, the DPI is associated with lower prices and narrower seller margins, and a contraction in the sales and operating costs of exposed public firms. This informational advantage predicts the targets of Amazon's private-label entry. After Amazon's entry, incumbent sellers suffer sharp declines in profitability, while exposed firms face heightened risk. Ultimately, this data-driven encroachment creates a welfare trade-off: the category's consumer surplus expands in aggregate, but it is reallocated away from the incumbent sellers who generated it.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

•From Dot-Com to AI: Technology Rebranding Twenty-Five Years Later

Cooper, M. J., Kim, H., & Won, P. Y. (2026). Available at SSRN.

- Media Coverage: *The Wall Street Journal* "AI Mania: The Reruns Have Started" (*The Intelligent Investor*, by Jason Zweig), 2026
- Twenty-five years ago, the dot-com era showed that investors rewarded technology branding regardless of whether firms possessed the underlying technology. We revisit this question using 35 U.S. firms that changed their corporate name, ticker symbol, or both to emphasize artificial intelligence (AI) between 2020 and 2026. Unlike the dot-com era, investors distinguish substantive AI activity from cosmetic AI rebranding: firms with substantive AI activity earn cumulative abnormal returns 90 percentage points higher over the three months following the rebranding. This advantage proves temporary, however, as the entire cohort subsequently experiences a sharp long-run reversal, suggesting that investors recognize genuine technological innovation but initially value it with excessive optimism.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

•Same Risk, Different Price: Dealer Rents in Single-Stock Leveraged ETFs

Kim, H., Han, J., & Won, P. Y. (2026). Available at SSRN.

- Presented at: *FMA Conference on Derivatives and Volatility (2026, scheduled)*
- Over-the-counter markets rarely reveal the price at which dealers bear risk. Single-stock leveraged ETFs are an exception, because a registered fund must disclose its swap terms. We hand-collect them and read the price directly. It runs about ten times the fund's stated fee, and it pays for risk a dealer cannot diversify, not for volatility. An industry fund is volatile but spread across many firms, and dealers finance it like a fund on the whole market. Only the single-stock funds pay more. In the same quarter, on the same stock, dealers charge materially different rates. Swap terms do not explain the gap, and it widens as a dealer takes on more. Part of the price is a rent on scarce dealer capacity.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

•Short-Term Lending and Usury Limits: Consumer Impact and Market Adaptation

Jansen, M., Liu, Z., Voges, R., & Won, P. Y. (2026) Available at SSRN.

- Presented at: *Financial Intermediation Research Society (FIRS) Conference (2025), International Banking, Economics, and Finance Association (IBEFA) 99th Annual WEAI Conference (2025), Wasatch Finance Conference (2024)*
- Alternative financial services (AFS), such as payday lending, provide valuable credit access to underserved consumers, but their impact on consumer welfare has sparked debate. Using borrower-level data from more than 2.8 million auto loan applicants, we investigate the effects of usury laws on AFS usage-and spillover effects on traditional credit markets. We find that interest rate caps significantly reduce AFS usage, particularly for low-credit borrowers, and that many consumers switch between AFS modes (such as from storefront to online lenders) when the credit supply is restricted. These restrictions are correlated with declines in credit scores, which limit consumers' access to traditional credit markets. The findings suggest that more targeted regulations could address underserved consumers' diverse needs and behaviors better than one-size-fits-all legislative approaches.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

•Does 0DTE Options Trading Increase Volatility?

Brogaard, J., Han, J., & Won, P. Y. (2026). Available at SSRN.

- Presented at: *China International Conference in Finance (CICF 2026), 13th Annual Conference on Financial Market Regulation (CFMR 2026)*
- Media Coverage: *Bloomberg "Zero-Day Options Are Reordering the Way the Stock Market Behaves", 2023*
- This paper examines the impact of Zero-Day-to-Expiration (0DTE) options trading on stock market volatility. The monthly trading volume of 0DTE options linked to indices increased from .08 million contracts in January 2011 to 34.4 million contracts in August 2023 and now accounts for 48% of the trading in index options. Using the staggered introduction of index weekly options as an instrument variable, we show that a one standard deviation increase in 0DTE options trading leads to 9.10% increase relative to the mean value of volatility, which is 15.91% of its standard deviation. Even after controlling for option market makers' gamma hedging, we find that the overall impact on volatility remains positive and is primarily driven by speculative retail investors.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

PUBLISHED PAPERS

•Cyclical consumption and expected stock returns: Evidence from the Korean capital market. 2021

Won, Y. W., Won, C., & Won, Y. (2021). *Global Business & Finance Review (GBFR)*, 26(3), 14-32.

- In this study, we empirically demonstrate how the new variable of 'cyclical consumption' can capture consumption risk and predict expected stock returns, which relationship is stronger and should be considered as the primary macro indicator for stock markets between KOSPI and KOSDAQ, and which specific industries exhibit stronger or weaker relationship with cyclical consumption in the Korean capital market.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

•Determinants of the Prices and Returns of Preferred Stocks 2020

Kim, S., Won, C. H., & Won, Y. W. (2020). *Asia-Pacific Journal of Business*, 11(2), 159-172.

- The purpose of this study is to investigate economic variables which have impact on the prices and returns of preferred stocks and to provide investors, underwriters, and policy makers with information regarding correlations and causal relations between them. Empirical results show that the significant variables influencing the prices and returns of preferred stocks are consumer sentiment index, consumer price index, industrial production index, KOSPI volatility index, and exchange rate between Korean won and US dollar.
- [\[Click Here for paper link\]](#)

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Languages: Both fluent at English and Korean (Dual Citizenship)

Developer Tools: SAS, STATA, R, Python, Matlab

SCHOLARSHIPS & GRANTS, AND AWARDS

- 2024 Dewey Research Data Grant (\$7,200) 2024
- University of Utah, MSE Rising Scholar Award 2022
- Seoul National University, Business School TA/RA Scholarship 2019-2021
- University of Seoul, Summa Cum Laude by Seoul Mayor 2018
- University of Seoul, Honors Scholarship for the Dean's List 2017